

A-List

A listing of the best products in different hardware and software categories

Who's in, who's out? The competition's hot, but only the winners get to this page—a listing of the best performing hardware and software that have been tested till date in different categories.

Every month, at the Digital Media Test & Research Centre, we carry out a series of comparison tests as well as individual product

reviews. Based on these tests, the best products have been listed here.

As different products get reviewed over the months, the top products might find themselves slipping out of the charts and replaced by the latest entrants in the market. So, keep your ears sharp and eyes open and keep yourself abreast of the latest cool products.

HARDWARE

Monitors (19-inch)

Samsung 955DF

- + Good build quality
- + Good colour results
- Screen clarity test fades out on corners



Contact: Samsung Electronics India Information & Telecommunication Limited

Phone: 011-6322517

Fax: 011-6932607

Price: Rs 32,000

Monitors (14-15 inch)

Viewsonic E53

- + OSD Support
- + 110 MHz video bandwidth



- + Good build quality
- No message signal if power cut off

Contact: Roop Technologies

Phone: 022-6631921

Fax: 022-6103919

Price: Rs 7,750

Monitors(17-inch)

ViewSonic PS775

- + Very good image quality
- + Support for high resolutions

Contact: Roop Electronics

Phone: 022-6175213

Fax: 022-6103919

Price: Rs 24,000

Graphics card

ASUS V8200 GeForce3 Deluxe

- + Unsurpassed video quality and speed
- Needs a fast CPU to get maximum result



Contact: Mnemonic Systems

Phone: 022-8010871

Fax: 022-8051761

Price: Rs. 35,000

Speakers

Creative SoundWorks DTT2500

- + True Dolby Digital-compliant sound
- Too clumsy stand for speakers



Contact: Compuage Infocom

Phone: 022-4913986

Fax: 022-4919069

Price: Rs 25,000

Soundcards

SoundBlaster Live! Platinum 5.1

- + Dolby Digital AC-3 compliant
- + High quality sound processing

Contact: Compuage Infocom

Phone: 022-4913986

Fax: 022-4919069

Price: Rs 12,500

Motherboards

ASUS P4T

- + Fits into any ATX cabinet
- + Good feature list

Contact: Rashi Peripherals

Phone: 022-8260258

Fax: 022-8190766

Price: Rs 16,500

Processors

Pentium 4 - 1.4 GHz

- + Fastest processor tested by us
- + Good build quality

Contact: Ockam Systems

Phone: 022-6234798

Fax: 022-6704503

Price: Rs 30,000 (kit including motherboard, 128 MB RDRAM and cabinet)

Hard disks (SCSI)

Seagate Cheetah 18XL - ST318404LW - 18GB

- + Blazingly fast
- Heats up quite a lot

Contact: ACI

Phone: 022-8595830

Fax: 022-8595831

Price: Rs 16,500

Hard disks (IDE)

IBM Deskstar 75GXP DTLA-307075 - 75GB

- + 10,000 RPM; good data transfer
- + 1 MB buffer

Contact: Wales Technologies

Phone: 022-3828100

Fax: 022-3828200

Price: Rs 18,000

DVD drives

Aopen 1640 Pro DVD

- + 16x DVD speeds; 512 KB cache
- + Good build quality
- Does not support DMA



Contact: Yogi Comp

Phone: 022-8806582

Fax: 022-8806582

Price: Rs 5,950

CD drives

ASUS CD-S500

- + Good performance
- Slightly inferior build quality

Contact: Rashi Peripherals

Phone: 022-8260258

Fax: 022-8190766

Price: Rs 2,700